Vijayan resumed talking after a pause. The morning after the assassination, Sivarasan came in very early with the news of Rajiv Gandhi's death. He had stayed the previous night in a different hideout. He scribbled something on a piece of paper and gave it to Nero to communicate to Jaffna. Did that mean Prabhakaran did not know about the outcome of the operation the previous night, as soon as Rajiv Gandhi was killed, the SIT asked. But Vijayan could not vouch for that. He didn't know what Sivarasan had written on the paper. His messages were coded, both when transmitted and when written down.

Sivarasan left after lunch. To Vijayan's surprise, Nero carried an AK-47 even inside the house. He looked tense. He said that the police would be coming. The next day, on 23 May, Sivarasan returned on a bicycle. He picked up his motorcycle and left again. The same evening, he returned with Shubha. And that night onwards, all three—Sivarasan, Shubha and Nero—did not sleep peacefully. They would be alert for any police action. Sivarasan would keep his 9 mm pistol under his pillow. He said he would kill at least a dozen policemen before getting caught. On 25 May, he and Shubha left for Tirupati, only to return the next day.[7]

Vijayan used to buy at least ten newspapers every morning, which Sivarasan and Nero would read, trying to figure out how far the investigation had progressed. Towards the end of the month, Sivarasan's photograph appeared in the newspapers. The first thing Sivarasan did after that was shave off his moustache. He also reduced the number of times he went out. Nero told Vijayan that Jaffna was going to send a boat in which Sivarasan, Shubha and he would escape from India. But it didn't happen while Sivarasan was still at the house. In fact, Nero sounded upset when there was no sign of a boat from Jaffna. And then came the next surprise. Photographs of Shubha also appeared in newspapers. Nero's name as Sivarasan's wireless operator had been doing the rounds in the media.[8]

Bhaskaran, mustering up the courage, asked Sivarasan if the buzz around them was getting hot. The mastermind agreed. What if some of their neighbours barged into their house and caught them? Even though Sivarasan assured him nothing of the sort would happen, he made some